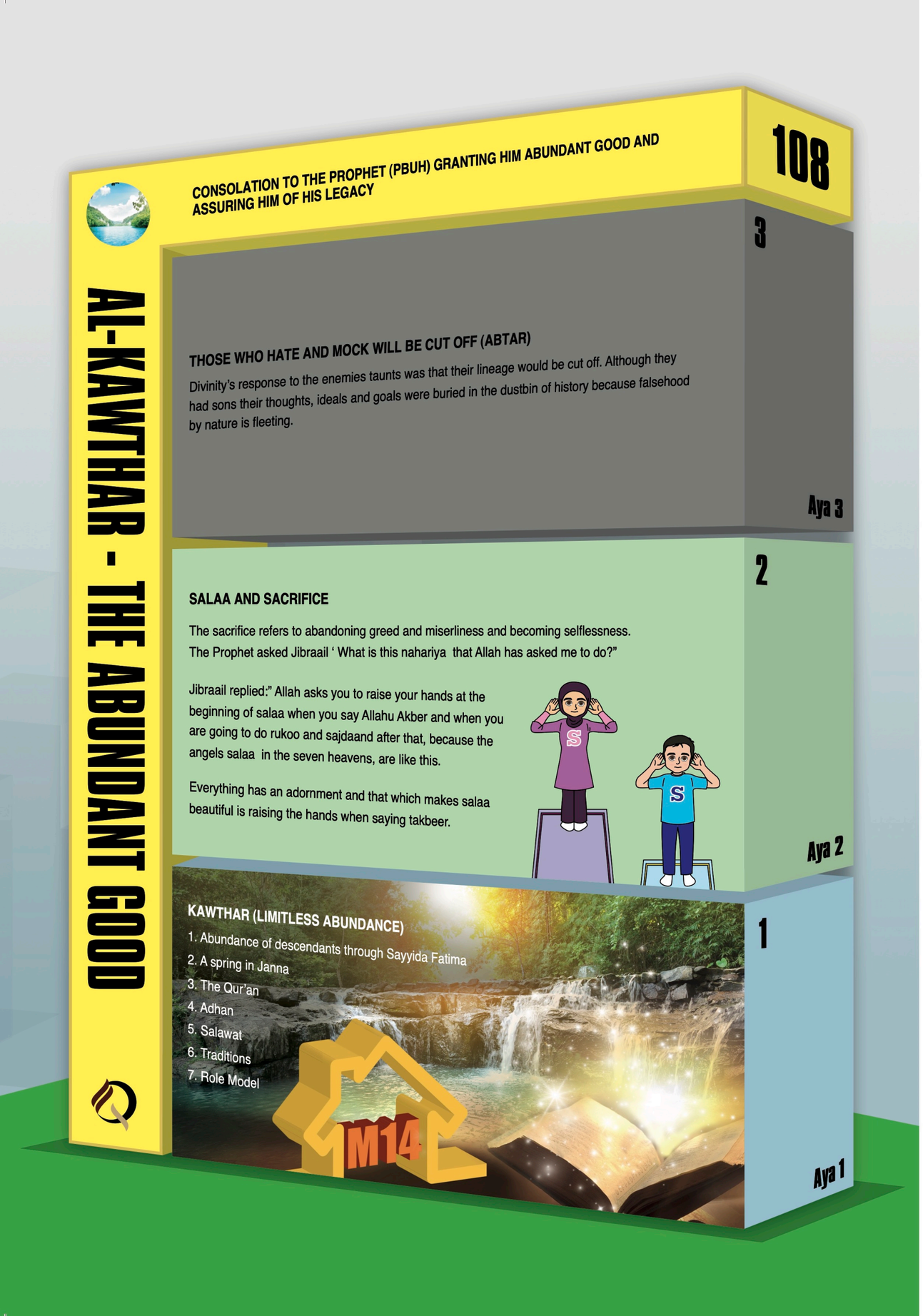

108. Al-Kawthar ~ The Abundant Good

3 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

CONSOLATION TO THE PROPHET (PBUH) GRANTING HIM ABUNDANT GOOD AND ASSURING HIM OF HIS LEGACY

DID YOU KNOW?

BOTH KAWTHAR AND TAKAATHUR ALLUDE TO ABUNDANCE BUT EXPRESS TWO DIAMETRICALLY OPPOSITE STATES. TAKAATHUR IS COVETOUS GREED WHILST KAWTHAR IS LIMITLESS ABUNDANT GOODNESS FROM DIVINITY.

SELECTED AYAAT

108:1 Certainly We have given you Al Kawthar (abundant good).
108:2 So pray to your Lord and Sustainer and make a sacrifice.
108:3 Certainly the one who hates (and reviles you) shall be the one who is " cut off" from posterity.

NARRATIVE

IT WAS A FUNDAMENTAL ARAB GOAL TO HAVE SONS. FATHER AND SONS WOULD RAID OTHER TRIBES. FATHERS CONSIDERED THEIR DAUGHTERS A BURDEN BECAUSE THEY COULD NOT FIGHT AND RISKED FALLING INTO ENEMY HANDS, WHICH WOULD TARNISH THE TRIBES HONOUR. THIS MINDSET CAUSED THE MAKKA MEN TO ASSUME THAT ISLAM WOULD ENDURE ONLY IN NAME AFTER THE PROPHET'S DEATH AS HE HAD NO SON TO PROTECT HIS LEGACY.

THE PROPHET (PBUH) HAD SON CALLED IBRAHEEM BORN TO MARIA QIBTIYYA WHO DIED WHEN HE WAS 18 MONTHS OLD.

HIS TWO SONS FROM SAYYIDA KHADIJA (QASIM & TAHIR) HAD ALSO DIED IN INFANCY. SOME PEOPLE INCLUDING HIS UNCLE ABU LAHAB TAUNTED HIM CALLING HIM 'ABTAR' WHICH MEANS AN ANIMAL WITHOUT A TAIL - ONE WHO HAD NO SUCCESSION.

THE PAIN OF LOSING HIS SON WAS EXTENUATED BY THOSE WHO CELEBRATED SAYING HIS LEGACY WOULD DIE WITH HIM. THIS CHAPTER WAS REVEALED IN REPLY TO THOSE WHO TAUNTED THE PROPHET (PBUH) AND GIVES CONSOLATION TO HIM AND EXPOUNDS ON THE IMMENSE FAVOURS GIVEN TO HIM WHICH WOULD BE TIMELESS AND IMMEASURABLE. HIS SUCCESSION AND LEGACY OF THE AHLULBAYT THROUGH SAYYIDA FATIMA, THE QUR'AN AND THE STREAM OF KAWTHAR IN JANNA.